

Built by the room

The Assembly is the one evening of the year the whole society is in a single place. That makes it the only occasion on which SLS can do what it cannot do anywhere else: name the partners, Council members, Chapter teams and contributors who carried the year, in front of everyone whose year they carried. Everything else the evening does follows from that.

PROPOSED DATE	TIME	VENUE	ROOM	NOT THIS YEAR
Saturday, November 21, 2026	6:30–10:30 p.m., four hours	Hena Experience Center, Misk City	~400 members, all invited	No graduation segment

Recognize. Show. Launch.

Close the SLS year by recognizing the people who carried it — partners, Council members, Chapter teams and key contributors — in front of the full membership; show what their work produced; and open 2027 with members committed to it before they leave the room.

Recognition comes first because it is the only thing on the agenda that cannot be done at any other SLS event, and because a society that shows its impact without naming who delivered it has told half the story.

- Every contributor group named publicly, each with **one specific line** on what they did and what it produced — never a category thanked in the abstract.
- **≥85%** of confirmed guests attend. In 2024, 320 of 468 registrants came — 68%.
- Overall satisfaction **≥85%** (2024: 76.8%) and agenda flow **≥85%** (2024: 69.8%, the lowest-scoring item on the survey).
- **≥60** members leave with a named 2027 commitment, and **≥3** introductions logged each on the network graph.

Built by the room

Everything on the screen tonight traces back to someone sitting in this room. Next year's will too.

The line makes the recognition argument without a speech — every milestone shown has a person attached, and they are present. It reads backward as a statement about the year that closed and forward as an instruction for the one opening. And it survives compression: it works as a stage graphic, an invitation subject line, and four words on a badge.

Everything here has a name on it — more literal, strong over the recognition wall, weaker as a stage line.

The year, in names — quieter and more formal, if the Council wants an honors evening rather than a community night.

One dependency for week one: the Arabic line, which has to carry the meaning rather than translate the words. The theme drives the invitation, the wall and the stage design, so it cannot be a late decision.

Four hours, one room, a stage

WHEN	Saturday, November 21, 2026, 6:30–10:30 p.m., ending with dinner
WHERE	Hena Experience Center, Misk City (proposed, pending site survey)
SCALE	All SLS members invited; around 400 expected. Private, invitation only
BALANCE	About 100 minutes on stage, 140 on the floor, in two alternating blocks
PRAYER	Isha (≈6:44 p.m.) falls inside the arrival window, so the program never stops for it
LANGUAGE	Bilingual throughout; simultaneous translation in scope

Hena is not a neutral ballroom. It is Misk City’s own experience center — an interactive exhibition, designed by Saudi Diyar for Misk City Company, telling the story of the Kingdom’s first nonprofit city. Members arrive inside the story of what the Foundation is building next, which does much of the showcase work before anyone reaches the stage. It also constrains: a built stage and seating for 400 has to be laid out around permanent installations, which makes the site survey a gating item rather than a formality.

With four hours and a real stage, **stage time is the scarce resource**. The test for every segment: does this need the stage, or is it better on the floor?

The arc of the evening

Recognition is threaded through the program rather than parked in an awards block, so nobody sits through sixty names in a row.

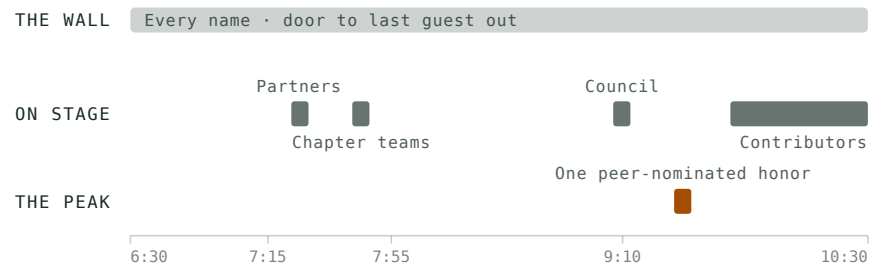
240 MINUTES · ~100 ON STAGE

TIME	SEGMENT	
6:30 p.m. · 45’	Arrival on the Misk City floor The badge scan lights your node on the network wall; the Wall of the Year names every contributor; members walk the exhibition. Isha (≈6:44) sits inside this window.	FLOOR RECOGNITION

TIME	SEGMENT	
7:15 · 30′	Opening, and the year Council welcome, then the year told by three members it happened to rather than reviewed from a deck. Partners are recognized at the top, because the impact is what they enabled.	STAGE RECOGNITION
7:45 · 10′	Chapters Chapter teams on stage as teams, not as a queue of individuals.	STAGE RECOGNITION
7:55 · 50′	The floor Impact Market and peer tables. Member-led stands, each carrying one ask — a partner, a pilot site, a regulator conversation. Commitments logged as they are made.	FLOOR
8:45 · 25′	Keynote dialogue Two chairs, a member moderating, questions collected from members beforehand.	STAGE
9:10 · 20′	The Council Outgoing members recognized at the handover, then three decisions put to the room and voted live: which chapter opens next, which visit the society funds, one change to member engagement.	STAGE RECOGNITION
9:30 · 15′	The honor, the welcome, the replay The peer-nominated honor of the year, new members welcomed into the society, then ninety seconds of the network graph replaying with the lights down.	STAGE RECOGNITION
9:45 · 45′	Dinner and open networking Contributor names on screen throughout. Seating drawn from the graph. 2027 commitments made on the way out, and everyone leaves with a personal network card.	FLOOR RECOGNITION
10:30 p.m.	Ends	

Three volumes, because sixty names is not a ceremony

Four groups deserve recognition — partners, Council, Chapter teams, contributors — and together they are likely sixty-plus names. Sixty walks to a stage would consume most of the stage time available and land precisely on the item the 2024 survey scored lowest. Recognition has to be designed at three volumes.



No group is thanked twice in the same register, and no stage block carries more than ninety seconds of names.

The Wall of the Year

TIER 1 · EVERYONE · ON ARRIVAL

A physical installation at the entrance carrying every partner, Council member, Chapter team and contributor, grouped by *what they did* rather than by rank. Sixty names honored in the time it takes to walk in — and, done properly, the most photographed object of the night.

In context, on stage

TIER 2 · FOUR GROUPS · NINETY SECONDS EACH

Each group is recognized inside the segment it belongs to: partners as the opening block turns to impact; Chapter teams during the Chapters segment, called up as teams; the Council at the handover; contributors named on screen through dinner. Every named recognition carries **one specific line** — what they did and what it produced. “Thank you for your support” is worth nothing to an executive.

The peer-nominated honor

TIER 3 · ONE · 9:30 P.M.

One honor, nominated by members four weeks out through the same flow that confirms their attendance. In a peer society the room’s choice carries more weight than a committee’s, and the nominations are useful twice: they decide the honor, and they hand the Track the specific evidence every Tier 2 line needs.

The letter home. A letter from SLS leadership to the board or CEO of each honored contributor’s organization. Recognition that reaches an executive’s employer outlives anything they can put on a shelf. It costs a signature and it is still remembered a year later.

The workstream this creates: evidence. Every named recognition needs one verified sentence, and those sentences do not exist yet. Ask Chapters and the Council for them during planning, not in the final week.

Four things a regular SLS event cannot do

The venue is the showcase. Members arrive through Misk City's own exhibition — the Foundation's next chapter as the backdrop to the society's last one. No other SLS event gets that room, and it means the first forty-five minutes are worth arriving for.

Chapter teams go up as teams. Six people on stage together for ninety seconds beats six separate walks, and it is a truer picture of how chapter work actually gets done.

Ninety seconds with the lights down. The network graph replays from doors to close, showing every connection made that evening. One deliberate image that people photograph — and everyone leaves with their own version of it on a card.

The 2027 board. Before dinner ends, members commit publicly to one thing for next year: host a visit, chair a circle, open a chapter, mentor a member. Photographed on the night, and it becomes the Council's pipeline in January rather than a follow-up email nobody answers.

What this note is waiting on

- ☐ Confirm November 21 and the 6:30–10:30 p.m. window against the Council diary and Hena's availability.
- ☐ Site survey at Hena before anything is contracted — a stage and seating for 400 inside a working exhibition is a layout question, not a logistics one.
- ☐ Does SLS already have named recognition categories? This note assumes not; if they exist, they replace Tier 2 wholesale.
- ☐ Approve the theme, and brief comms on the Arabic line in week one.
- ☐ Confirm the Council will put three decisions to a live vote. The segment does not work as a presentation.
- ☐ Agree who signs the letter home, and to whom it goes.
- ☐ Open peer nominations four weeks out — needs the member list and the profile flow ready.